

Reading

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A Historic Win for the City Team

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think happened in the match?
- Have you ever watched a match that ended in a surprising result?

Last Saturday, the City Basketball Team achieved a historic victory in the regional championship final, defeating their long-time rivals by a score of 78 to 74. The match, held at the packed City Sports Hall, kept thousands of supporters on the edge of their seats until the final minute.

After the game, the team captain spoke to reporters. She said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. She explained that the players had trained twice a day for the past month and that their hard work had finally paid off. She also added that the whole team had believed in victory even when they were losing by ten points in the third quarter.

The coach told journalists that the turning point of the match had come when a young substitute player scored three important baskets in a row. He said the young player had shown great courage under pressure and that he was extremely proud of the entire squad. He also mentioned that the team would begin preparing immediately for the national tournament next month.

Fans who attended the match praised both teams for their sportsmanship. One supporter said the atmosphere in the hall had been unforgettable, with both sets of fans cheering loudly throughout the game. Local newspapers described the victory as one of the most exciting sporting moments the city had seen in years, and many are already looking forward to the national tournament.

1. What was the final score of the match?
 - a. 74 to 78
 - b. 78 to 74
 - c. 80 to 74
 - d. 78 to 70
2. The captain said she had never felt so proud of her teammates. — *True / False*
3. The coach said the turning point came when a young _____ player scored three baskets in a row.
4. According to the text, what will the team do next?
 - a. Retire from competition
 - b. Change their coach
 - c. Prepare for the national tournament
 - d. Play a friendly match
5. Rewrite in reported speech: "The atmosphere in the hall was unforgettable," the supporter said. (*The supporter said...*)

6. The team had been losing by ten points in the third quarter before the comeback. — *True / False*

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After you read

- Why do you think the captain mentioned the team's training schedule?
- Do you think fair sportsmanship is as important as winning? Why or why not?

Interview: Life of a Young Athlete

Before you read

- What questions would you ask a young professional athlete?
- What do you think is the hardest part of being a professional athlete?

Our school magazine recently interviewed Deniz Aksoy, a nineteen-year-old swimmer who recently qualified for the national team. In the interview, Deniz talked openly about training, sacrifice, and staying motivated.

When asked about her daily routine, Deniz explained that she woke up at five every morning to train before school. She said that balancing school work and swimming was the most difficult part of her life as a student athlete. She added that her family had always supported her, even when she felt like giving up.

The interviewer asked Deniz what advice she would give to young people who wanted to become athletes. She replied that discipline was more important than natural talent, and she said that anyone could improve with consistent practice. She also mentioned that she had failed to qualify for the national team twice before finally succeeding this year.

Deniz told the interviewer that her biggest goal was to represent her country at an international competition. She said she was not afraid of losing, because every competition taught her something new. Finally, she admitted that without the support of her coach and family, she would never have achieved her dream.

The interview ended with Deniz thanking her school for allowing her to combine her studies with intense training, and she encouraged other students to follow their passions, whatever they might be.

1. Deniz said she woke up at _____ every morning to train.
2. According to Deniz, what is more important than natural talent?
 - a. Money
 - b. Discipline
 - c. Luck
 - d. Equipment
3. Deniz qualified for the national team on her first attempt. — *True / False*
4. Rewrite in reported speech: "My family has always supported me," Deniz said. (*Deniz said...*)
5. What is Deniz's biggest goal, according to the interview?
 - a. To become a coach
 - b. To win a scholarship
 - c. To represent her country internationally
 - d. To change sports

After you read

- What personal quality do you think helped Deniz succeed the most?

- Would you be willing to make similar sacrifices for a goal you care about?

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